

SEAG-style practice tests

the catapult papers

A stylized illustration of a person with dark hair and sunglasses, wearing a black shirt, sitting in the basket of a catapult. The catapult is grey and has two long arms extending upwards and outwards. The person's legs are extended outwards, and their feet are visible, wearing black shoes with white soles. The catapult is mounted on a base. A green banner with white text is overlaid across the middle of the illustration.

the warm-up series

Name: _____

Score: _____

Warm-Up 9

2026 edition

Notes for parents

The Warm-Up Series of The Catapult Papers introduces children to the Transfer Test process in a gentle and accessible way. These papers are intended for P6 pupils and reflect the stage at which schools typically begin early preparation, around eight months before the official exams. At this point in the school year, some relevant English and Maths skills will not yet have been covered in class. Although a small number of these concepts may appear within the Warm-Up papers, the overall difficulty level has been moderated to provide a first, confidence-building look at SEAG-style questions.

As children progress through the Warm-Up Series, they will gradually become familiar with the structure, pacing, and style of SEAG assessments. Completion of this series should help prepare them for the more challenging papers within the main Catapult Papers series (20 papers), which continue the progression toward full P7 readiness.

The official time limit for the Transfer Test is 60 minutes. However, because this is a practice paper, no time limit is printed. Parents may decide how long to allow for completion, depending on their child's needs and stage of learning.

This test paper may be written on, but answers must be recorded on the separate answer sheet provided. Guidance on how to do this is included at the top of that page. An answers page has also been provided for marking. Each correct answer is awarded one mark, and no question is worth more than one mark. Half-marks are not recommended. In the English section, misspelled answers should only be accepted when spelling is not part of the skill being tested. When spelling accuracy is central to the question (e.g. plurals, verb endings), the response should be marked incorrect if spelled wrongly.

Spaces for recording the final score are provided on both the cover page and the answer sheet. Parents may record the result either as a percentage or as a score out of 56.

Finally, please remember that these are practice tests. Early scores are not an indication of eventual performance. At this stage, the purpose of the Warm-Up Series is to build familiarity, develop confidence, and introduce children gradually to the range of skills and question types they will meet later in the Transfer Test journey.

Permission to use this paper is granted for one child only. No photocopying or sharing of the test is permitted. A separate series of The Catapult Papers is available exclusively for schools.

English

In this exercise there are some mistakes with **punctuation** or use of **capital letters**. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**. If there is **no** mistake, mark **N**.

Punctuation Exercise

1 The beast opened it's mouth wide and roared, 'You'll pay for your foolishness!'
A B C D

2 Forgetting to look over his shoulder Jake boldly approached the cave's opening.
A B C D

3 'Correct me if I'm wrong,' asked Louie, 'but haven't we met before'?
A B C D

4 Mum's strawberry cheesecake tasted every bit as delicious as Uncle George's.
A B C D

5 'It'd be fair to say,' Mrs Marshall admitted, 'that when december begins, I think less
about teaching and more about Christmas.'
A B C D

In this exercise you have to choose the **best** word, or **group of words**, to complete each numbered line so that the sentences make sense and are written in correct English. Choose the best answer and **mark its letter on your answer sheet**.

Grammar Exercise

6 Although Lauren gets nervous before every performance, she always
[risen] [rose] [rise] [raises] [rises] to the occasion once she's on the stage.
A B C D E

7 'If I'd [known] [knew] [know] [knowned] [knows] that you were coming, I'd
A B C D E
have prepared something to eat.'

8 She couldn't imagine life [between] [on] [beyond] [in] [through] the small
A B C D E
town where she grew up.

9 [Their team and our's] [There team and ours] [Our team and their's]
A B C
[Our team and theirs] [Us and them] were the best in the league.
D E

10 The Gibsons hadn't spoken to the Wilsons [since] [for] [from] [under]
A B C D
[around] two and a half years.
E

In this exercise there are some **spelling** mistakes. On each numbered line there is either **one** mistake or **no** mistake. Find the group of words with the mistake in it and mark its letter on your answer sheet. If there is no mistake, mark N.

Spelling Exercise

11 Rosie sincerely regretted the offensive remark she had made to her brother.

A B C D

12 The group meetings, tipically long and dull, ended very early on this occasion.

A B C D

13 Thomas would regularly confuse his friends with his wierd expressions.

A B C D

14 Sevaral hundred people had been queuing up outside the concert venue.

A B C D

15 'Never forget,' added Mr Carter, 'to start a completely new paragraph whenever a different character begins to speak.'

A B C D

Read the whole poem carefully, then answer the questions that follow.

Wings of Resilience

1. Beneath the canopy of the Northern Lights,
2. Brent geese commence their annual flight.
3. Faces set to the East, the gaggle soars.
4. The chorus of wings departs Canada's shores.

5. Over boreal forests and spotless lakes,
6. Their journey unfolds as the daylight breaks.
7. Through vast horizons, a migratory tide,
8. Guided by lights on this celestial ride.

9. Through blue kingdoms and windswept spaces,
10. Brent geese confront a spectrum of faces.
11. Storms brew in the heavens, tempest's might,
12. Mother Nature puts up its menacing fight.

13. The ocean's breadth, a relentless expanse,
14. Treacherous currents, a dangerous dance.
15. Yet, resilient feathers weather the strife,
16. Gliding through mayhem on a voyage of life.

17. Into nighttimes's cloak with no moment for sleep,
18. They look to the stars for the route they must keep.
19. Moonlit illusions – illusions that trick,
20. Yet, through the unknown, to their course they stick.

21. But perilous noises linger in the air,
22. As the geese cross realms with hunters there.
23. Greenland's shores, a serious threat,
24. Feathers tremble, hearts with caution set.

25. Echoes of gunshots: unsettling notes,
26. Hunters await, with rifles on boats.
27. But in the dance of their quest for survival,
28. These graceful beasts are nearing arrival.

29. To Strangford's haven they make their way,
30. Where the Irish Sea heralds a new day.
31. Wings weary but triumphant, a courageous story,
32. The geese descend, a feathered inventory.

33. In Strangford's embrace, a rest is found,
34. Amidst the reeds on sacred ground.
35. The marshland whispers tales untold,
36. Of journeys etched in their feathers' folds.

37. Nature's ballet, a graceful transition,
38. From sinister skies to peaceful fruition.
39. Brent geese complete their annual migration.
40. And provide their goslings with inspiration.

Please answer these questions. (Look at the poem again if you need to.)
You should choose the **best** answer and mark its letter on your answer sheet.

16

Which of the following statements describes the rhyming pattern of this poem?

- A There is no rhyming pattern in this poem.
- B In each verse, odd-numbered lines rhyme with each other, and even-numbered lines rhyme with each other.
- C In each verse, the first two lines rhyme with each other but the second two lines do not.
- D In each verse, the first two lines rhyme with each other, and the second two lines do the same.
- E In each verse, the very first word rhymes with the very last word.

17

Which of the following options tells us the journey details that the poem describes?

- A from Greenland to Strangford, via Canada
- B from Canada to Greenland, via Strangford
- C from Strangford to Canada, via Greenland
- D from Strangford to Greenland, via Canada
- E from Canada to Strangford, via Greenland

18

Which of the following words in the poem is a noun that means ‘a group of geese’?

- A canopy (line 1)
- B gaggle (line 3)
- C migratory (line 7)
- D spectrum (line 10)
- E expanse (line 13)

19

‘Over boreal forests and spotless lakes’ (line 5)

Which of the following words is closest in meaning to ‘boreal’?

- A boring
- B real
- C Arctic
- D flying
- E borrowed

20 How regularly do Brent geese make the journey that is described in the poem?

- A once per year
- B twice per year
- C once every two years
- D once per week
- E once every ten years

21 What danger awaits the Brent geese in Greenland?

- A stormy skies
- B dangerous currents
- C illusions created by the moonlight
- D hunters' gunshots
- E sleepiness

22 Which of the following lines from the poem contains a metaphor?

- A line 2
- B line 13
- C line 28
- D line 34
- E line 37

For these questions you have to **write your answers**, neatly, in the boxes provided on your answer sheet.

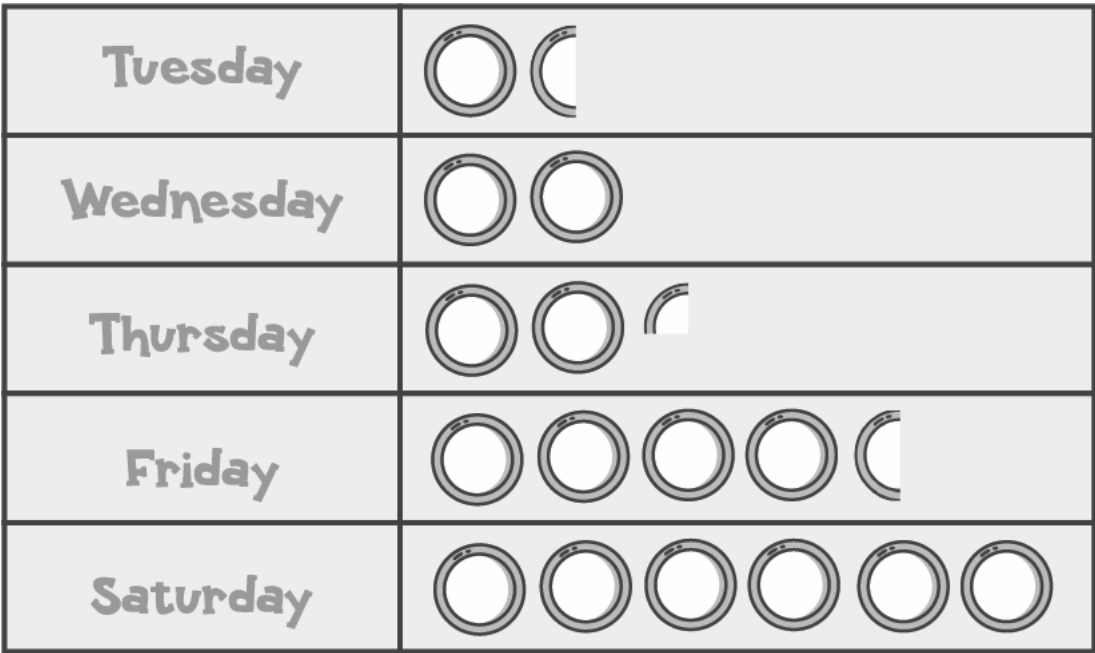
23 'Northern Lights' (line 1) is a two-word proper noun. Which other two-word proper noun appears in the first twelve lines of the poem?

24 Which noun, in lines 25 - 32, suggests that the number of geese could be counted and then recorded on a list?

- 25** The word 'echoes' (line 25) is the plural form of the noun 'echo'.
What is the plural form of the noun 'piano'?
- 26** There is a compound word in lines 33 - 36. What is this word?
- 27** Which word, in lines 37 - 40, is the name given to 'young geese'?
- 28** Which one part of speech are the following as they appear in the passage?
chorus (line 4), **spaces** (line 9), **mayhem** (line 16), **day** (line 30)

Maths

29 This pictogram chart shows the number of meals that were served at a restaurant during a five-day period.



Eight meals were served at the restaurant on Wednesday.

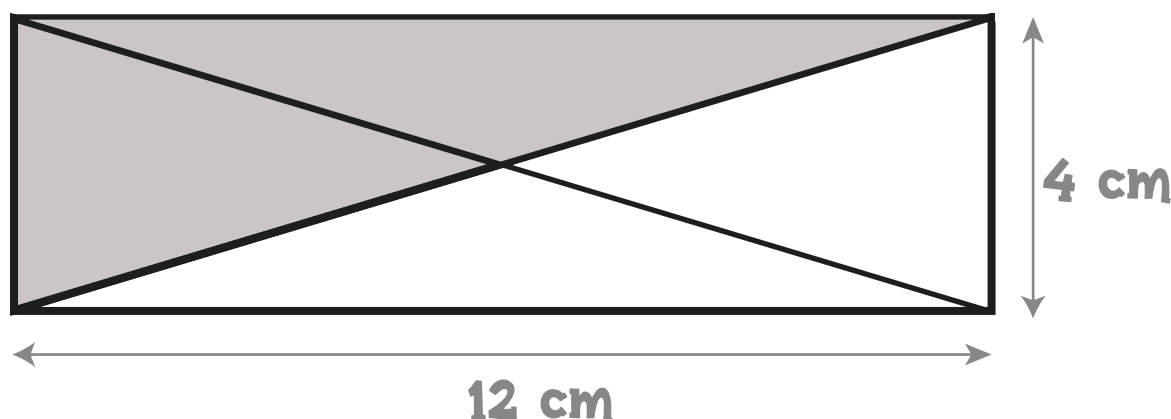
How many meals were served at the restaurant on Friday?

- A 4½ meals
- B 9 meals
- C 16 meals
- D 18 meals
- E 65 meals

.....

30

A rectangle has two diagonal lines drawn on it, creating four triangles.



What is the combined area of the two shaded triangles?

- A 16 cm² B 24 cm² C 32 cm² D 36 cm² E 48 cm²
-

31

Yasmina, Barbara and Beatrice are each thinking of different numbers.

Yasmina's number is 88 more than Barbara's number.

Barbara's number is two-thirds of Beatrice's number.

Beatrice's number is 432.

What is Yasmina's number?

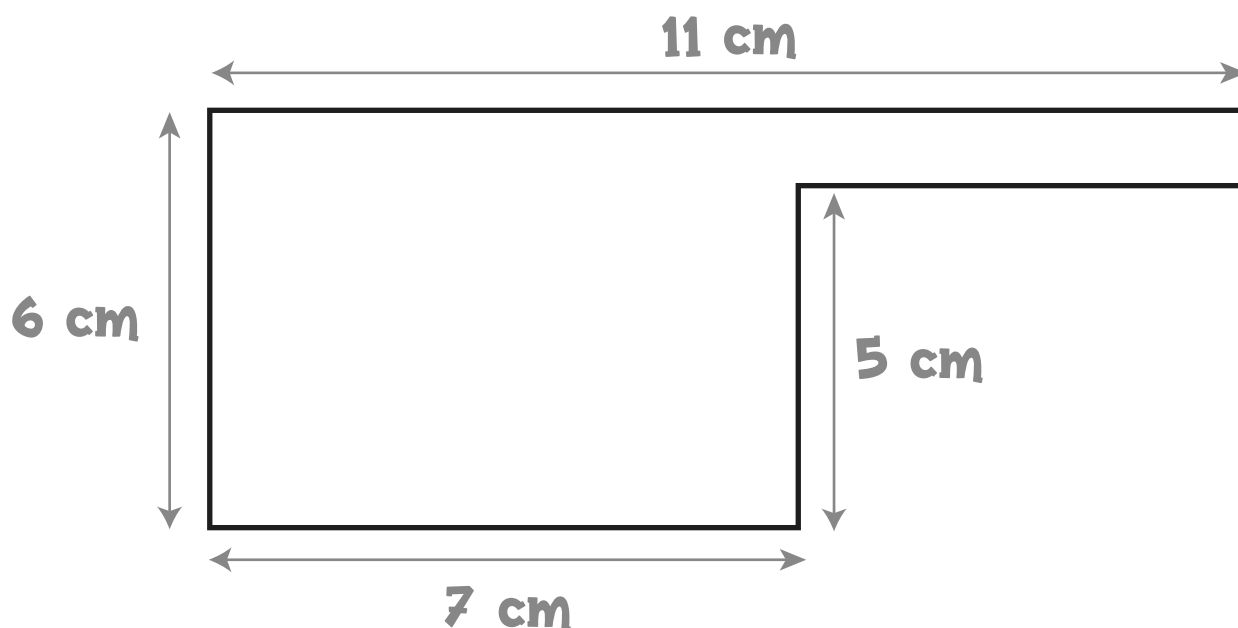
- A 200 B 344 C 376 D 560 E 736
-

32

How many square numbers are less than 100?

- A 1 B 3 C 9 D 10 E 25
-

33



What is the perimeter of this shape?

- A 29 cm B 30 cm C 33 cm D 34 cm E 46 cm

1d1f1c

34

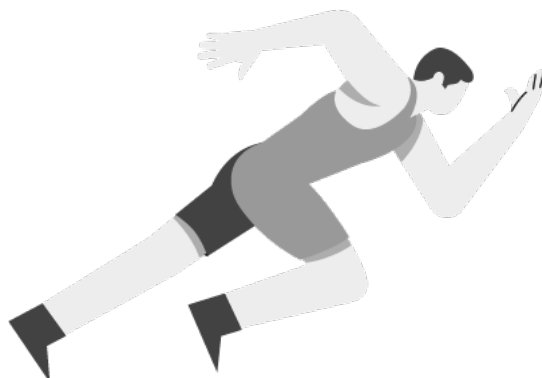
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What will be the value of the 6 digit after this number has been divided by 1000?

- A 6 tens
B 6 units
C 6 tenths
D 6 hundredths
E 6 thousandths

35

Harvey begins a training session. He sprints for 10 seconds then rests for one minute. He repeats these steps until he has sprinted a total of ten times.



How much time will have passed from the beginning of Harvey's first sprint to the end of his final sprint?

- A** 1 minute 40 seconds
 - B** 10 minutes
 - C** 11 minutes
 - D** 10 minutes 40 seconds
 - E** 11 minutes 40 seconds
-

36

A 200 g container of Greek yogurt costs 80p.

A larger container of the same Greek yogurt weighs one kilogram, and costs £3.50.

How much cheaper is it to buy a one-kilogram container of this Greek yogurt than to buy one kilogram of the yogurt in the smaller containers?

- A** 30p
 - B** 50p
 - C** £2.70
 - D** £4.30
 - E** £7.50
-

37

IN	→ calculation 1 →	→ calculation 2 →	OUT
8	→		27

What are the two missing calculations in this function machine?

- A $\times 6$ then $- 21$
 - B $\times 5$ then $+ 13$
 - C $\times 7$ then $- 28$
 - D $\times 4$ then $+ 3$
 - E $\times 8$ then $- 35$
-

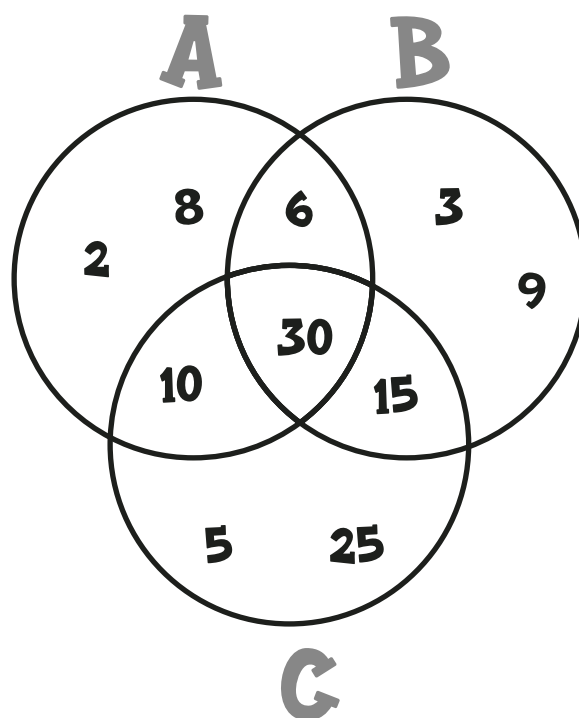
38

Which of the following measurements is the best estimate for the height of a two-storey house?

- A 0.1 m
 - B 1 m
 - C 10 m
 - D 50 m
 - E 100 m
-

39

Ten numbers have been placed inside this Venn Diagram. The labels for the three circles have not been given.



In order, from Circle A to Circle C, what could the labels for the three circles be?

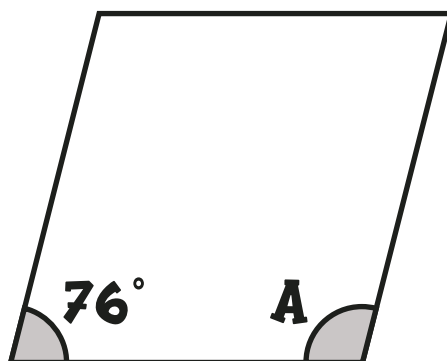
- A A = prime numbers; B = square numbers; C = odd numbers
- B A = multiples of 2; B = multiples of 3; C = multiples of 4
- C A = cube numbers; B = square numbers; C = multiples of 5
- D A = prime numbers; B = multiples of 3; C = odd numbers
- E A = multiples of 2; B = multiples of 3; C = multiples of 5

40

Which of the following numbers is the best estimated answer to 302×19 ?

- A 600
- B 3000
- C 3200
- D 6000
- E 30000

41



What is the size of Angle A in this rhombus?

- A 76° B 90° C 104° D 108° E 120°
-

42

Several pizzas were bought for a children's birthday party. Each pizza was divided into eight equal-sized slices.

When the party had ended, $5\frac{1}{4}$ pizzas had been eaten.

How many slices of pizza had been eaten at the party?

- A 5.25 slices
B 40 slices
C 41 slices
D 42 slices
E 44 slices
-

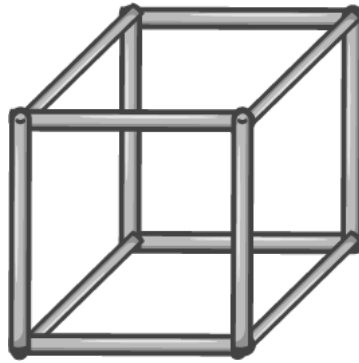
43

What is 40% of 50?

- A 10 B 20 C 25 D 30 E 40
-

44

Identical drinking straws have been used to create this cube.

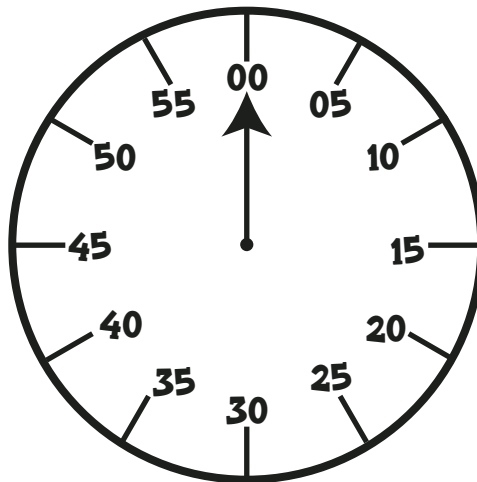


Exactly 3 metres of drinking straws were used to complete the cube.

What is the length of one drinking straw?

- A 2.5 cm B 5 cm C 25 cm D 30 cm E 50 cm
-

45



At which number on the stopwatch will the hand be pointing after it has turned 600° clockwise?

- A 35 B 40 C 45 D 50 E 55
-

46

	number of faces	number of edges	number of vertices
triangular prism	?	9	6
cone	2	?	0
square- based pyramid	5	8	?

What is the sum of the three missing numbers in this table?

A 11

B 12

C 13

D 14

E 15

47

What is the mean of the first four multiples of four?

A 8

B 9

C 10

D 11

E 12

48

A restaurant bill of £138 is split evenly among four friends.

How much does each friend pay?

A £34

B £34.02

C £34.05

D £34.20

E £34.50

49

These are the times for three different movies being shown at a local cinema. Each movie is being screened three times per day. The running time for each movie has also been provided.

movie title	running time	first screening	second screening	third screening
Captain Duck	87 mins	15:05	17:45	20:00
Worst Party Ever	90 mins	15:30	16:50	19:10
The Bad Drummer	95 mins	16:00	18:15	20:25

Hamish arrives at the cinema at twenty minutes to seven in the evening. He chooses to watch the next movie that is available to watch.

At what time does Hamish's movie finish?

- A 18:20 B 19:50 C 21:27 D 20:40 E 22:00
-

50

Which of these decimal numbers is equal to $1\frac{4}{20}$?

- A 0.14 B 0.28 C 0.06 D 0.6 E 0.7
-

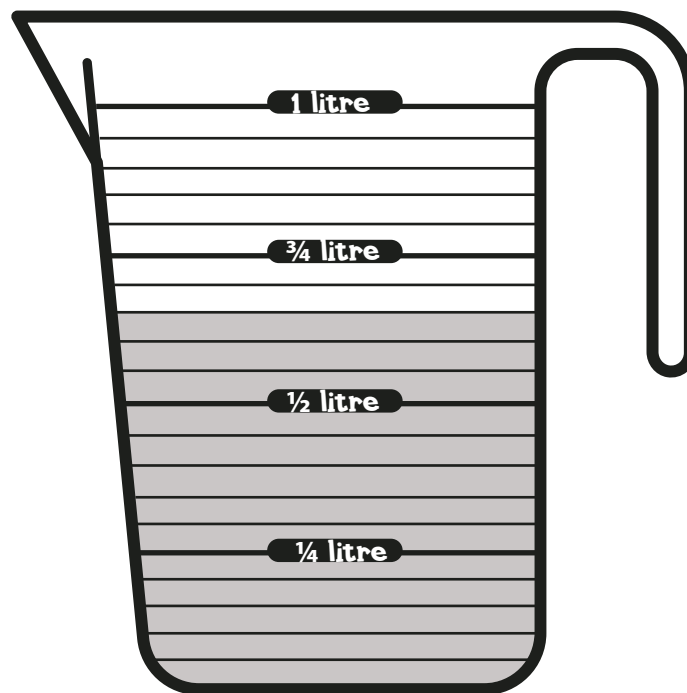
For questions 51 - 56, you have to **write your answers** in the boxes provided on your answer sheet. The units of measurement have been given.

51

Rionach counts aloud all the multiples of 6 that are less than 50.
Marco counts aloud all the multiples of 8 that are less than 50.

How many of the numbers in Rionach's list of numbers also appeared in Marco's list of numbers?

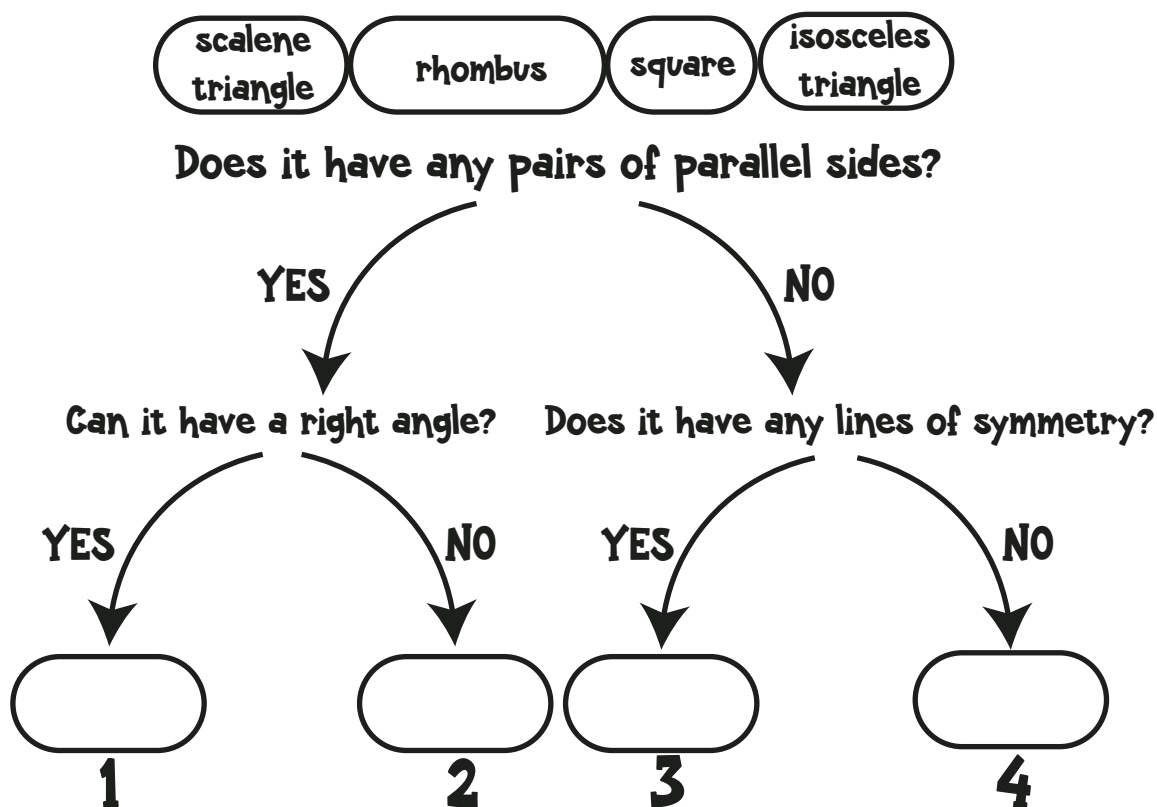
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52

How many millilitres of liquid are in this container?

.....

53



Which of the four shapes at the top of the decision tree should have its name written inside box 3?

54

Carolina is facing south, then performs the following movements:

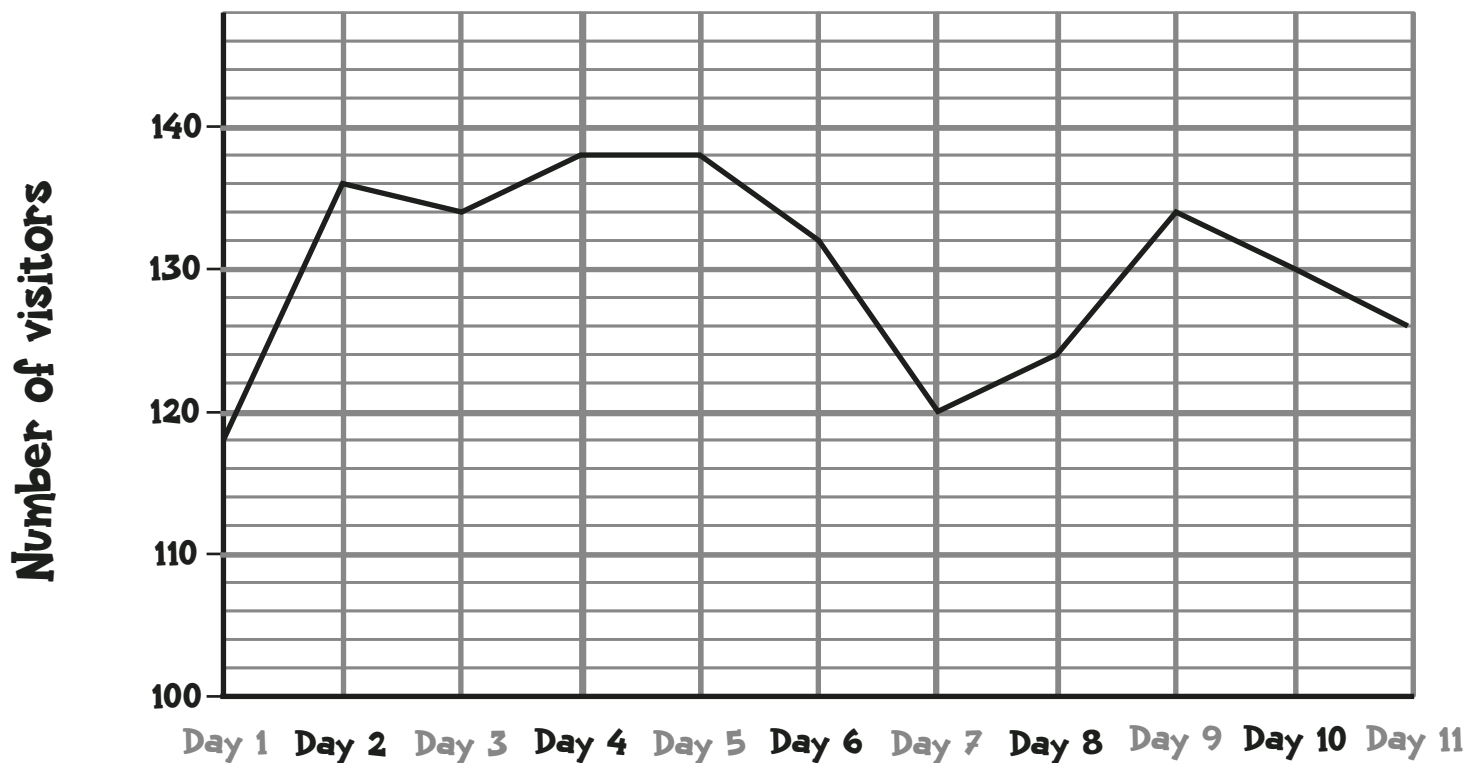
- one quarter-turn anticlockwise
- 270° turn clockwise
- 45° turn anticlockwise

In which direction is Carolina now facing?

55

This line graph shows the number of visitors to a museum on eleven consecutive days.

Museum Visitors



On which of the eleven days were there 12 fewer museum visitors than on the previous day?

56

3.7 7.1 10.5 _____ 17.3 _____

What are the two missing numbers in this sequence?

The Catapultalogue



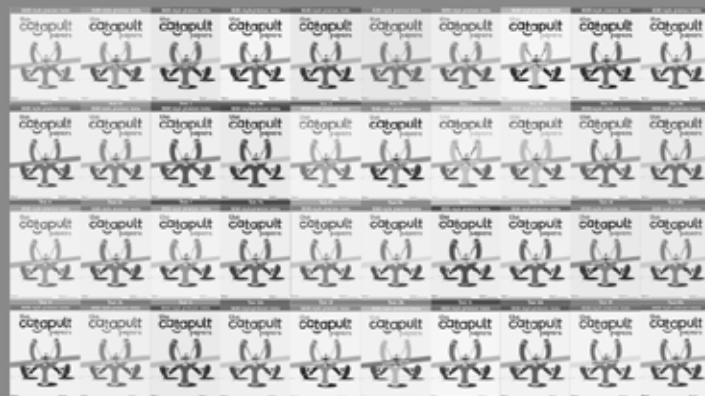
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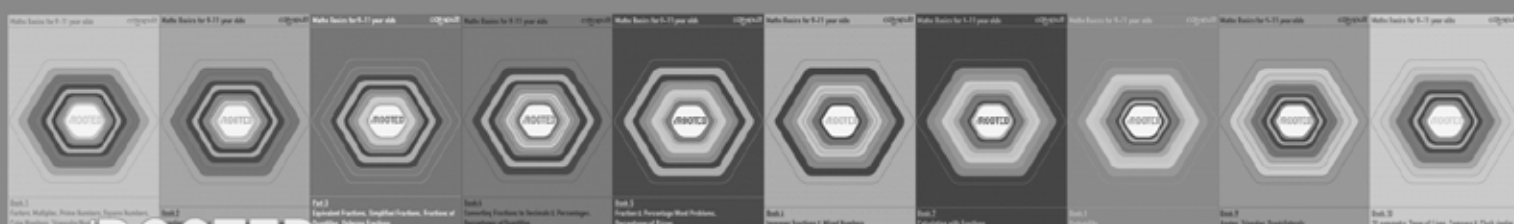
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Catapult is a one-man tuition service. Based in East Belfast, Trevor Veale has been working with primary pupils from 4 to 11-years-old on a full-time basis since 2019.

A former Year 3 and Year 6 teacher, Trevor is now fully booked as a private tutor through to the end of 2030. His teaching resources not only include *The Catapult Papers*, but also *Target Practice* and *Rooted*. All of these materials can be purchased at www.catapult-tuition.com